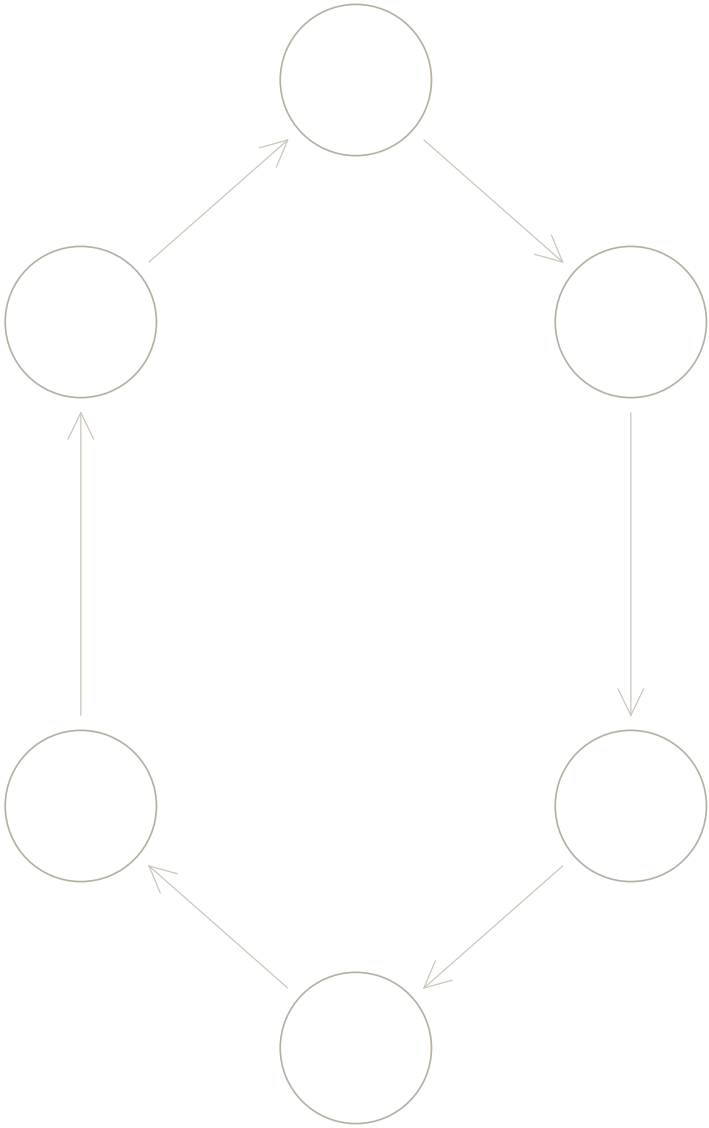Six-stage cycle